



what they could from the harsh environment before moving on. Bedouins originated in Saudi Arabia and other countries of the Arabian Peninsula. Today they also live in Jordan, Egypt, and Israel. They travel in

family groups and trace their descent through the male line back to a particular clan, and beyond that to a tribe. They have a strict code of honor and even those who are no longer nomads are proud of their heritage.

Bedouins belong to the Muslim religion, though they sometimes maintain pre-Islamic beliefs and customs too.



GOD'S GIFT

Camel breeding is traditionally the most noble Bedouin profession. Camels are known as "God's gift" because they are so well adapted for the desert. Camel breeders travel huge distances in large groups, sometimes surviving for months on camel milk alone.

AN ORAL TRADITION

Bedouin are excellent poets and record their history through poems that are passed down from one generation to the next. These may be accompanied by instruments such as a drum or a harp like the one shown here.

